

Claude × Excel Cheatsheet

Formulas, shortcuts & prompts to make spreadsheets fun.

Beginner-Friendly

Visual

Print-Ready

fx

Formulas

SUM, IF, XLOOKUP, FILTER and friends.

Ks

Shortcuts

Fly through Excel without your mouse.

AI

Prompts

Ask Claude to build, fix, explain Excel.

What's inside

- 01 **Essentials** — SUM · AVERAGE · COUNT · MIN/MAX
- 02 **Logic & Conditions** — IF · IFS · AND/OR · IFERROR
- 03 **Lookups** — XLOOKUP · INDEX/MATCH · VLOOKUP
- 04 **Text & Dates** — CONCAT · TEXT · TODAY · DATEDIF
- 05 **Power Moves** — FILTER · UNIQUE · SORT · SUMIFS
- 06 **Shortcuts** — Speed-run with your keyboard
- 07 **Claude Prompts** — Magic phrases for Excel work

01 · Essentials

The everyday formulas you'll use 1,000 times.

Math & Stats

SUM

=SUM(range)

Add up everything in the range.

ex: =SUM(B2:B10)

AVERAGE

=AVERAGE(range)

Mean of all numbers in the range.

ex: =AVERAGE(B2:B10)

COUNT

=COUNT(range)

Count cells that contain numbers.

ex: =COUNT(B2:B10)

COUNTA

=COUNTA(range)

Count non-empty cells (text + numbers).

ex: =COUNTA(A2:A100)

MIN

=MIN(range)

Smallest number in the range.

ex: =MIN(B2:B10)

MAX

=MAX(range)

Largest number in the range.

ex: =MAX(B2:B10)

ROUND

=ROUND(num, digits)

Round to N decimals (banker-friendly).

ex: =ROUND(A1, 2)

ABS

=ABS(number)

Absolute value (drop the minus sign).

ex: =ABS(-7) → 7

PRO TIP

Lock a cell with \$: \$A\$1 stays put when you drag the formula. A\$1 locks the row, \$A1 locks the column.
Press F4 (or Fn+F4 on Mac) while editing a reference to cycle through lock styles.

02 · Logic & Conditions

Make your spreadsheet think for you.

If this, then that...

IF

=IF(test, ifTrue, ifFalse)

Branch based on a condition.

ex: =IF(A1>10, "big", "small")

IFS

=IFS(test1,v1, test2,v2, ...)

Cleaner than nested IFs for many cases.

ex: =IFS(A1<60, "F", A1<70, "D", A1<80, "C", TRUE, "A")

AND

=AND(cond1, cond2, ...)

TRUE only when every condition is TRUE.

ex: =AND(A1>0, A1<100)

OR

=OR(cond1, cond2, ...)

TRUE if at least one condition is TRUE.

ex: =OR(A1="yes", A1="ok")

NOT

=NOT(condition)

Flip TRUE to FALSE and vice versa.

ex: =NOT(A1=0)

IFERROR

=IFERROR(formula, fallback)

Hide ugly errors with a friendly value.

ex: =IFERROR(A1/B1, 0)

SUMIF

=SUMIF(range, criteria, sum_range)

Sum only cells that match a criteria.

ex: =SUMIF(A:A, "NYC", B:B)

COUNTIF

=COUNTIF(range, criteria)

Count cells that match a criteria.

ex: =COUNTIF(A:A, ">100")

How IF thinks

A1 > 10 ?

TRUE → "big"

FALSE → "small"

Read it like a sentence:

"If A1 is greater than 10, write big — otherwise write small."

03 · Lookups

Find a value in one column → return a value from another.

The lookup family

XLOOKUP (recommended)

=XLOOKUP(lookup, lookup_arr, return_arr, [if_not_found])

Modern, flexible. Replaces VLOOKUP/HLOOKUP. Returns any column, no order needed.

ex: =XLOOKUP("NYC",A:A,B:B,"n/a")

VLOOKUP

=VLOOKUP(lookup, table, col_index, FALSE)

Classic. Looks up in the FIRST column, returns Nth column to the right.

ex: =VLOOKUP("NYC",A:C,3,FALSE)

INDEX/MATCH

=INDEX(return_col, MATCH(lookup, lookup_col, 0))

The OG power-couple. Works left, right, any direction.

ex: =INDEX(B:B, MATCH("NYC",A:A,0))

HLOOKUP

=HLOOKUP(lookup, table, row_index, FALSE)

Like VLOOKUP, but searches across the first ROW.

ex: =HLOOKUP("Q1",A1:E5,3,FALSE)

How XLOOKUP works

City	Country	Sales
NYC	USA	\$120K
Tokyo	JP	\$95K
Paris	FR	\$80K
Lima	PE	\$45K

=XLOOKUP("NYC", A:A, C:C)

1. Look for NYC in column A
2. Return matching value from column C
3. Result: **\$120K**

04 · Text & Dates

Wrangle words. Tame the calendar.



Text

CONCAT

=CONCAT(a, b, ...)

Glue text together.

ex: =CONCAT(A1, " ", B1)

LEFT

=LEFT(text, n)

First N characters.

ex: =LEFT("Hello",3) → Hel

MID

=MID(text, start, n)

N characters starting at position.

ex: =MID("Hello",2,3) → ell

UPPER

=UPPER(text)

SHOUTY MODE.

ex: =UPPER("hi") → HI

TEXTJOIN

=TEXTJOIN(sep, ignore, ...)

Glue with a separator (skip blanks).

ex: =TEXTJOIN(", ", TRUE, A:A)

RIGHT

=RIGHT(text, n)

Last N characters.

ex: =RIGHT("Hello",2) → lo

LEN

=LEN(text)

How many characters?

ex: =LEN("hi") → 2

TRIM

=TRIM(text)

Remove extra spaces.

ex: =TRIM(" hi ") → hi

Dates

TODAY

=TODAY()

Today's date (auto-updates).

ex: =TODAY()

NOW

=NOW()

Date + current time.

ex: =NOW()

DATEDIF

=DATEDIF(start, end, "unit")

Difference in Y, M, or D.

ex: =DATEDIF(A1, B1, "D")

EOMONTH

=EOMONTH(date, months)

End-of-month. ±N months from a date.

ex: =EOMONTH(A1, 0)

FUN FACT

Excel stores dates as numbers. 1 = Jan 1, 1900. So 45000 ≈ Mar 15, 2023. Format as Date to reveal!



Dynamic arrays (Excel 365)

FILTER

=FILTER(array, condition, [if_empty])
Return only rows that match — spills automatically.

ex: =FILTER(A2:C100, B2:B100>1000)

UNIQUE

=UNIQUE(range)
Strip duplicates. Hello, distinct list!

ex: =UNIQUE(A2:A100)

SORT

=SORT(array, [by], [order])
Sort ascending (1) or descending (-1).

ex: =SORT(A2:A100, 1, -1)

SORTBY

=SORTBY(array, by_array, order)
Sort one range by the values of another.

ex: =SORTBY(A2:A10, B2:B10, -1)

SEQUENCE

=SEQUENCE(rows, [cols])
Generate a list of numbers instantly.

ex: =SEQUENCE(10) → 1..10

SUMIFS

=SUMIFS(sum, r1, c1, r2, c2, ...)
Sum with multiple conditions. Multi-criteria SUMIF.

ex: =SUMIFS(C:C, A:A, "NYC", B:B, ">100")

COUNTIFS

=COUNTIFS(r1, c1, r2, c2, ...)
Count rows that meet multiple criteria.

ex: =COUNTIFS(A:A, "NYC", B:B, ">100")

AVERAGEIFS

=AVERAGEIFS(avg, r1, c1, ...)
Average with conditions.

ex: =AVERAGEIFS(C:C, A:A, "NYC")

What's a spill?

One formula → many results that overflow into neighbour cells. The blue border is the spill range

1	2	3	4
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06 · Shortcuts

Stop reaching for the mouse.

WINDOWS

Ctrl	+	C	Copy		
Ctrl	+	V	Paste		
Ctrl	+	Z	Undo		
Ctrl	+	Y	Redo		
Ctrl	+	S	Save		
Ctrl	+	F	Find		
Ctrl	+	T	Make a Table		
Ctrl	+	Shift	+	L	Toggle Filters
Ctrl	+	Arrow	Jump to edge		
Ctrl	+	Shift	+	Arrow	Select to edge
Ctrl	+	;	Insert today		
Ctrl	+	Shift	+	:	Insert time
Alt	+	=	AutoSum		
Alt	+	Enter	New line in cell		
F2	Edit cell				
F4	Toggle \$ on refs				

MAC

Cmd	+	C	Copy		
Cmd	+	V	Paste		
Cmd	+	Z	Undo		
Cmd	+	Y	Redo		
Cmd	+	S	Save		
Cmd	+	F	Find		
Ctrl	+	T	Make a Table		
Cmd	+	Shift	+	F	Toggle Filters
Cmd	+	Arrow	Jump to edge		
Cmd	+	Shift	+	Arrow	Select to edge
Ctrl	+	;	Insert today		
Cmd	+	Shift	+	:	Insert time
Cmd	+	Shift	+	T	AutoSum
Ctrl	+	Opt	+	Return	New line in cell
Ctrl	+	U	Edit cell		
fn	+	F4	Toggle \$ on refs		

07 · Claude Prompts for Excel

Copy, paste, profit.



Magic phrases

BUILD

"Build me an Excel file that tracks monthly expenses by category, with a summary sheet and a chart of the top 5 categories."

EXPLAIN

"Explain this formula in plain English, line by line: =INDEX(B:B,MATCH(1,(A:A="NYC")(C:C>100),0))"*

FIX

"My VLOOKUP returns #N/A for some rows. Here's a sample. Find the cause and rewrite with XLOOKUP."

CONVERT

"Convert this messy CSV into a clean spreadsheet: trim whitespace, parse dates, and split the name column."

ANALYZE

"Look at the attached sales.xlsx and tell me the 3 most surprising trends. Add a chart to back each up."

AUTOMATE

"Write the Excel formula that flags any row where the order date is more than 30 days before the ship date."

You've got this. Now go cell-ebrate.

Keep this cheatsheet handy. Or just ask Claude — that works too.